

Resolutions. Not the kind with pixels...

FOR OVER TWO DECADES, WHICH IS HOW LONG I'VE BEEN WRITING ABOUT TECHNOLOGY (MOST OF IT SPENT WRITING FOR DIGIT), I would daydream about life in 2020. What would it be like, would space travel be possible for us average Joes? Would we build space elevators, or hyperfast transport tubes? Would we all be unconscious in pods, living life vicariously through a robot's eyes? Not once did I think 2020 would be the worst year of the decade, and a majority of the world was just sitting around waiting for it to end. If anything, just before midnight on December 31, people are going to be more thrilled about saying goodbye to 2020 than they are excited to see what 2021 holds in store.

Not that 2021 is magically going to be different, of course. It will actually be more of the same because this dreadful virus is not going to go away in a hurry. At best we can vaccinate against the most devastating of strains and hope it doesn't mutate too fast. What we have to realise is that 2020 is not a blip that will be forgotten about on January 1, 2021. This is going to be the "new normal" for quite a few years to come. And of course, this means that instead of hoping the world changes so you can be comfortable again, you're going to have to be uncomfortable for a bit before you find a new comfort zone for yourself.

And thus the title of this column. We all resolve to change in some way every new year (no matter which month of the year your new year starts from), and we all resolve to improve ourselves, yet very few actually succeed. January is a very hot month for gym memberships the world over, and in February they're back to being at half capacity again...

Personally, my pre COVID-19 life was pretty much the same as my life post the start of the pandemic. 2020 has not actually been that different for me, except for having my son not go to school for a few months in March and April. Apart from that, I was already working from home, and was already spending way too much time indoors in front of screens, and addicted to all things tech. If I resolve to do anything different it will be purely in terms of health and fitness – that's pretty much as boring a new year resolution as you can get, eh?. But I also plan to read more. Not on screens, but actual books and magazines.

Outdoors. In the sunshine and fresh air! By the time you read this mag and decide to write back, we will be closing in on January 1 anyway, so please remember to tell me what you're resolving to do differently in 2021.

The purpose of this column was not to talk about my own silly little goals for myself, but to try and understand how it is we can serve you better. Instead of waiting until January to ask you what you want to see more of, or less of, in 2021, I want to know now how we can do better.

This magazine, as you know it now, has a few different buckets of information that we provide to you. For example via reviews and component lists, Top 3, etc., we provide you with buying advice, so that you know whether a product suits your needs or not. Level up and workshops are there to help you learn how to do things with the stuff you already own. The Fast Track tries to teach you a totally new skill, varying from developer oriented topics to everyday software or services that you're bound to use. dmystify takes you on a journey of science discovery, trying to make complex science interesting. The DVD and eDVD exist to expose you to new software, games, lectures and more... to broaden your field of view. SKOAR! exists purely to entertain and to allow us all to indulge in our gamer fantasies. And of course there are many more little sections and subsections that cater to a variety of needs we think that you have.

I'd really like to not guess though. So one of the resolutions I am making is to get in touch with you more often to try and take your feedback and make a concentrated effort to incorporate it into your favourite magazine. In case you get an email from me or someone in my team, asking you to fill in a questionnaire for a reader survey, or inviting you to be in a focus group, or to talk to us on the phone or WhatsApp, I hope you will oblige us. Our goal is simple. We just want to make sure we are meeting your needs and being your technology navigator. 📡



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